policy towards China. It rather provides evidence of India's "hedging" approach to China, which involves deepening alignment with other major powers in the Indo-Pacific as a way of developing the resources to adopt a mix of cooperative and credible long-term confrontational policies (if necessary) toward China. India, being a friendly power and both a major security actor and an economic powerhouse, offers unique partnership opportunities for Japan in this regard. If Japan can hold up its end of the bargain and continue to invest in India's long-term potential, the core bargain of their strategic partnership will hold and evolve based on a much stronger foundation.

Notes

1 See Mohan, C. Raja (2004), *Crossing the Rubicon: The Shaping of India's New Foreign Policy*. New York: Palgrave Macmillan.

2 Jaishankar S. (2000), "India-Japan Relations after Pokhran II," *Seminar*, No. 487. Accessed 6 April 2020. www.india-seminar.com/2000/487/487%20jaishankar.htm.

3 Ministry of Foreign Affairs [hereafter MOFA], Government of Japan (1998), "Comments by the Chief Cabinet Secretary on Measures in Response to the Second Nuclear Testing Conducted by India." 14 May.

4 Jaishankar (2000).

5 Ibid.

6 The New Indian Express (2017), "A Strong India in Japan's Interest, Says Japan PM Shinzo Abe at Bullet Train Foundation Event," 14 September.

7 MOFA, Government of Japan (2017a) "Japan-India Summit Meeting," 14 September. Accessed 6 April 2020. www.mofa.go.jp/s_sa/sw/in/page3e_000747.html.

8 The Japan Times (2017), "Japan-India Civil Nuclear Pact," 19 May.

9 Tunsjø, Øystein (2017), "U.S.-China Relations: From Unipolar Hedging toward Bipolar Balancing," in Robert S. Ross and Øystein Tunsjø, eds., *Strategic Adjustment and the Rise of China: Power and Politics in East Asia*, Ithaca, Cornell University Press, pp. 41–68.